21. Ibid.
22. Balraj Madhok, ‘Back to the roots’, *Hindustan Times*, 8 November 2001.
23. Interview with a long-standing UP MLA who spoke on the condition of anonymity, 9 and 10 June 2020.
24. TNN, ‘I’m a Hindu; No need to celebrate Eid: Yogi Adityanath’, *The Times of India*, 7 March 2018, http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/articleshow/63195659.cms.
25. Pankaj Shah, ‘Yogi Adityanath doubles financial grant for pilgrims of Kailash Mansarovar’, *The Times of India*, 25 March 2017, http://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/articleshow/57829099.cms. For details, see state government orders listed on Department of Religious Affairs, Government of Uttar Pradesh website: http://updharmarthkarya.in/booking/Home. Parallel to this, the UP government’s Minority Welfare and Waqf Department’s budgets were significantly increased: going up from Rs 1,365.31 crore in 2015-16 (under the previous Akhilesh Yadav-led SP government) to Rs 3,159.26 crore in 2020-21. Data from Minority Welfare and Waqf Department, Government of Uttar Pradesh, ‘Vittiya Avashyaktao ka Uddeshyavaar Vargikaran’, http://minoritywelfare.up.gov.in/en/page/progress-reports.
26. The Union government used to provide subsidies on airfare for Haj pilgrims since the 1950s. The Supreme Court, in a two-bench judgment by Justice Aftab Alam and Justice Ranjana Prakash Desai in 2012, ruled that the Haj subsidy should be ‘done away with’ by 2022. The apex court found the subsidy both unsustainable in law and inconsistent with the Quran, which enjoins it for those believers who can ‘afford the expenses (for one’s conveyance, provision and residence)’. The ruling, based on its reading of the Quran, hence specifically distinguished between subsidies for the Haj and those for other religious activities by other religions. Following this judgment and the recommendations of a Haj Policy Review committee set up by Ministry of Minority Affairs, this subsidy was gradually reduced from 2013 and withdrawn by the Modi government in 2018. The Union government’s subsidy for Haj pilgrims provided to the airlines amounted to Rs 577.07 crore in 2014-15, Rs 529.51 crore